

Phrasal verbs

belt out [I] *informal* to sing a song or play an instrument loudly: *She was belting out some of her favourite songs.*

die down [I] to become less active, strong or violent: *The sea is a bit calmer now. I think the storm is beginning to die down.*

go away (for the weekend / for a while etc.) [I] to spend some time in another place, especially for a rest or holiday: *Are you planning to go away at Easter?*

go on (+ to do) [I] to do something after you have finished doing something else: *After passing her exams, she went on to become an extremely successful lawyer.*

launch into [I] to start something very lively or energetic: *After lunch the Prime Minister launched into a lengthy speech about immigration, which caused lots of debate.*

let down [I] to disappoint somebody who was relying on you: *I'm counting on you to help me – don't let me down!* Also **to be / feel let down**: *I felt really let down when I didn't get my promotion.*

put off [I] to delay doing something because you do not want to do it now: *I put off telling him about the bill until he felt better.*

roll down (your window) [I] to open the window of a car: *Roll down the window, will you? It's hot in the back.* (opposite = **roll up**: *He rolled his trouser legs up and went for a walk on the beach.*)

send up [I] BrE *informal* to show how silly something or somebody is by imitating them in a funny way: *The film sends up all those Hollywood blockbuster movies.*

sing along (+ with) [I] to sing at the same time as somebody else who is already singing: *Sing along if you know the words.*

sell out (+ of) [I] to have no more of something to sell: *I'm afraid that tonight's performance is completely sold out.*

stand out [I] to be clearly better than the rest: *There are some very talented musicians in the orchestra at the moment, but Nigel really stands out.*

turn into [I] to change somebody or something into something else: *You'll never turn me into a salesman. I'm not made for it.*

turn out [I] to happen in a particular way that you did not expect: *Don't worry, I'm sure things will turn out fine in the end.*

turn up [I] *informal* to appear or arrive: *The party was a huge success. We really didn't expect so many people to turn up.*

Exercise

Complete the sentences with a suitable phrasal verb.

- After he had started the tournament so well, all his fans were extremely _____ by Kolinsky's defeat in the semi-finals.
- We had expected an audience of up to fifty- so imagine our disappointment when just seven people _____.
- You should've filled in your application form weeks ago: you can't _____ it _____ any longer or you'll miss the deadline.
- When she saw a passer-by, Jenny _____ the car window to ask for some directions to the nearest bank.
- Everyone knew the words to his last song, so most of the audience _____.
- What everyone had expected to be a pleasant, relaxing evening _____ to be a real nightmare.
- We always _____ in August, usually to our holiday home by the sea.
- Even at the age of 65, Billie Lee showed she still has a powerful voice, when she _____ all of her old hits from the 1960s.
- It seems that the minister wasn't too pleased about that comedian who _____ him _____ on TV the other night.
- It took a while for the shouting to _____, allowing him to continue his speech about the unpopular immigration laws.
- He was a shy young man at first, but several years in the army _____ him _____ a completely different person.
- There are a lot of excellent entries for this year's art competition: but for me there is one painting which really _____, and fully deserves first prize.
- The whole audience suddenly _____ a rousing version of the national anthem which lasted for several minutes.
- After leaving the group in 1999, he _____ to record a number of extremely successful solo albums.
- The show was _____ weeks ago- you'll never get a ticket now.

Idioms

(be) bored to tears to be extremely bored: *I was sitting next to my girlfriend's mother at the wedding. She appeared to be bored to tears!*

cry your eyes out to cry for a very long time: *My niece really enjoyed Bambi, but she cried her eyes out at the end. It was so sad!*

give one hundred per cent to do something with maximum effort: *I want the whole team to give one hundred per cent this afternoon and hopefully we'll get into the finals.*

(be) in floods of tears to cry a lot: *We all enjoyed the film but it was really sad. I was in floods of tears at the end.*

(be) in the public eye to be on television / radio a lot because you are famous: *Since her husband became Prime Minister, Mrs. Shelley has been in the public eye much more.*

(have the) last laugh to be successful / be proved right in the end, after people have criticised or defeated you earlier: *You may think you're right, but I'll have the last laugh.*

laugh your head off to laugh loudly and for a long time: *Nick was laughing his head off at my joke but my boss didn't find it at all funny.*

man of few words a person who speaks very rarely: *Don't expect Robert to say much – he's a man of few words.*

(with) not a stitch (on) to wear no clothes at all: *I still have some embarrassing baby photos of myself with not a stitch on.*

out of the blue to be completely unexpected: *I hadn't thought about Jane for years. Her phone call came right out of the blue.*

pass with flying colours to get very high marks in an examination or test: *Congratulations! You've passed your driving test with flying colours.*

(be) scared stiff (+ of) to be extremely frightened: *Sorry, but I can't touch that creature, I'm scared stiff of snakes.*

shoulder to cry on to give sympathy to someone when they are unhappy or upset: *My brother is so kind to me. He is always there when I need a shoulder to cry on.*

stand firm to not change your actions or opinions: *The church council is standing firm on its attitude to divorce.*

(take a) short cut a quicker and more direct route than the usual one: *We arrived on time. However, we would've been late if we hadn't taken a short cut across the fields.*

Exercise

Complete the sentences with a suitable idiom.

- 1 She was so disappointed at missing the party that she just lay on her bed crying _____.
- 2 I felt very depressed and lonely, but unfortunately I didn't have a _____ and had to deal with everything myself.
- 3 I have to confess that I'm _____ of spiders. They just terrify me.
- 4 After preparing so carefully for her driving test, I'm confident that Lorraine will _____.
- 5 It's not going to be easy for us to win this match, but if we all _____ there's no reason why we can't do well.
- 6 We arrived on time, but only because we took a _____ across the park.
- 7 I was sitting next to Mr. Machin at dinner and he hardly said anything all evening: he certainly is a _____.
- 8 I had no contact at all with James for over a year, until one day he phoned me _____ and invited me for lunch.
- 9 United lost the previous match to City 1-0, but they had the _____ by beating them 3-0 in the final.
- 10 The concert was far too long. Everyone was _____ by the end.
- 11 If you're a celebrity, you expect to be followed by journalists and photographers, but being _____ can have its disadvantages.
- 12 Although he received a lot of criticism for his views, the Prime Minister _____ and refused to change the new policy on taxation.
- 13 Imagine my shock and surprise when she got out of the shower and answered the door with _____!
- 14 I knew something serious had happened when I came home to find my daughter in _____.
- 15 There is no finer feeling for a comedian than when you tell a joke and you see that the audience are _____.

Miscellaneous phrases

bring influence / charm / power to bear (+ on) to use all your influence / power / charm to get what you want: *The tobacco companies are bringing all their influence to bear on the government.*

burst into tears / out laughing to start crying / laughing suddenly: *I've no idea why she suddenly burst out laughing.*

close to tears to be almost crying: *We were all close to tears when the song ended.*

forget your lines to forget the words you have to say in a play or TV show: *I was so nervous I nearly forgot my lines.*

disallow to declare something illegal because a rule has been broken: *The goal was disallowed by the referee.*

(have) mixed emotions (+ about) to be unsure whether you have positive or negative feelings about something: *I had mixed emotions as I watched him leave.* Also **mixed feelings**.

politically correct (P.C.) language or behaviour to avoid because it is offensive to black people, women, minority groups etc: *It's not politically correct to talk about 'disabled' people.* (opposite = **non-P.C.**).

punch line the last few words of a joke which make it funny or surprising: *Don't laugh till you hear the punchline.*

no laughing matter a problem or issue which should be treated seriously: *Losing your job is no laughing matter.*

put-down something you say that is intended to insult someone, often in an amusing way: *It was a very cruel put-down, but I couldn't help laughing.*

situation comedy (= sitcom) a popular type of television or radio programme with a series of amusing stories about a particular set of characters: *Fawlty Towers is still one of the most popular situation comedies on TV.*

slapstick comedy / comedian comedy where the actors fall down, throw things at each other etc: *I love all those slapstick comedies from the 1920s.*

(suffer from) stage fright to feel nervous before going to perform in front of a large audience: *I was suffering from stage fright, and could hardly move as I waited to go on.*

stand-up comedy / comedian comedy where one person tells jokes, stories etc. to the audience: *Before going into films, Steve Mills had a successful career as a stand-up comedian.*

(be / feel) stressed out informal to be so worried and tired that you cannot relax: *I'm stressed out by looking after five children all day.*

Exercise

Complete the sentences with a suitable phrase.

- I always ruin jokes by forgetting the _____!
- Bob looks completely _____ since he started that new job- I believe he's working over fifty hours a week.
- Isabelle looked so funny with her face painted that we all _____.
- I could see that he was _____ at the news about his job, so I decided not to say any more.
- As a young musician, José suffered from terrible _____ and was unable to walk on stage without shaking.
- The Italian team were furious when the goal _____ by the referee, supposedly because one of their players was offside.
- That's my Family!* is a popular _____ about the trouble a middle-aged couple have with their three rebellious children.
- The deputy Prime Minister is _____ all his influence _____ on his party to vote for Mr. Belling.
- I have to say that I have _____ about this proposal: many people will welcome it, but I can't help having my doubts.
- In the days of silent films, many of the old _____ involved people throwing pies at each other.
- The actor Eddie Murphy has also had a successful career as a _____ appearing in small comedy clubs telling stories and jokes.
- You're right, looking after a sick relative is no _____. I'm sorry.
- I find it really surprising that such an experienced actress should _____ so often.
- The American TV hostess is famous for her devastating _____: guests on her show should beware!
- It is no longer _____ to refer to "air stewardesses": they are called "flight attendants" nowadays.

Useful Language

Choose the correct way to complete the sentences. (See the Useful Language box on p.22 of the Student's Book).

1 Feeling completely desperate I...	a) ... decided to run away. b) ... laughed my head off.
2 To his relief...	a) ... the money was still there on the table. b) ... someone had stolen his wallet.
3 In desperation he...	a) ... phoned the police. b) ... smiled quietly to himself.
4 We were in for a shock when...	a) ... we fell asleep. b) ... we opened the garage door.
5 Before long...	a) ... we had spent all our money. b) ... I nearly screamed with terror.
6 By this time...	a) ... we decided to see what was behind the door. b) ... we were getting cold and hungry.
7 At that point...	a) ... I still regret what happened. b) ... I thought I was going to die.
8 From that day on...	a) ... I can still remember his expression. b) ... they never argued again.
9 From that moment onwards...	a) ... I never trusted him again. b) ... we looked at each other and burst out laughing.
10 Ten years went by...	a) ... before we noticed the door was unlocked. b) ... until we heard any news of him.
11 In the end...	a) ... we decided to abandon the search. b) ... of the holidays, we were all dying to get home.
12 But the story doesn't end there because...	a) ... two years later, he wrote to me saying... b) ... two years later, nobody could remember.